

GSEB CLASS 10 SOCIAL SCIENCE

Chapter 2: Cultural Heritage of India: Traditional Handicrafts and Fine Arts - Section B

SECTION B

Q1. Write about 'Sangeet Ratnakar'.

- **Author & Origin:** This fundamental musicological treatise was composed by Pandit Sarangdev during the medieval period.
- **Geographical Knowledge:** Living in Devgiri (Daulatabad) in central India, Sarangdev was uniquely well-versed in both North Indian (Hindustani) and South Indian (Carnatic) classical music traditions.
- **Expert Endorsement:** Prominent music scholar Pandit Vishnu Narayan Bhatkhande declared 'Sangeet Ratnakar' to be the most authentic and authoritative text on Indian music.
- **Structural Significance:** It serves as an essential reference manual for understanding ragas, pitch variations, rhythm systems, and technical musical concepts.

Q2. Give information about Kathakali dance.

- **Origin & Definition:** Kathakali is a renowned classical dance-drama form originating from the state of Kerala, translating literally to a 'story-play'.
- **Attire & Facial Painting:** Dancers wear voluminous pleated skirts, elaborate headgear, and intricate facial make-up (*Mukhavat*) coded in colors to represent noble, heroic, or demonic characters.
- **Dramatic Expression:** The performance is non-verbal; dancers convey complete narrative epics purely through stylized facial expressions (*Bhava*) and symbolic hand gestures (*Mudras*).
- **Stage Tradition:** Accompanied by traditional percussion like the Chenda and Maddalam, the artists perform under the light of a single large oil lamp (*Nilavilakku*).

Q3. Name the metal items produced by the artisans of Lothal.

- **Craftsmanship Expertise:** Artisans of Lothal were highly skilled metallurgists who melted and cast copper and bronze to manufacture essential items.
- **Agricultural & Working Tools:** They crafted sharp tools including sickles, drills, needles, circular saws, and chisels used for carpentry and construction.
- **Domestic Utensils:** A wide variety of metallic household vessels, storage containers, cups, and cooking pots were manufactured for daily life.
- **Weapons & Decorative Art:** They produced defensive and offensive weaponry such as spearheads, arrowheads, and daggers, alongside small cast metal figurines and ornaments.

Q4. Write about Rasa.

- **Definition & Origin:** Raas is a traditional circular dance performed with rhythmic movement and song, deeply rooted in devotional Gujarati culture.
- **Mythological Association:** Religious traditions hold that Lord Krishna performed the divine 'Raas Leela' for his supreme devotee, Narsinh Mehta, establishing the dance form.
- **Festival Celebrations:** In Gujarat, Raas is enthusiastically performed across all communities during major festive occasions like Navratri and Janmashtami.
- **Cultural Evolution:** Primarily executed as 'Dandiya Raas' using decorative sticks, it evolved significantly under the influence of the Vaishnav sect into a core folk tradition.

Q5. Write about the Dhamaal dance of Siddis.

- **Community Origin:** Performed by the Siddi community, originally from Africa, who settled in isolated hamlets like Jambur in the Gir forest of Gujarat.
- **Musical Instruments:** Dancers play the 'Mashira'—a dried coconut shell filled with pebbles, covered with cloth—alongside small drums (*Dhamal*) and percussion.
- **Performance Style:** Performers wear animal skins, peacock feather crowns, and headbands, moving rhythmically in circular formations while shouting "Ho-Ho" reverberations.
- **Unique Features:** The dance features energetic physical movements, rhythmic footwork, and precise vocal mimicry of wild forest animals and bird calls.

Q6. "Rajasthan's Bikaner city is known for its gem-setting work." Explain this statement.

- **Ancient Art Form:** Gem-setting (Jadau work) is an intricate Indian jewelry art where precious stones are embedded into refined gold structures.
- **Royal Patronage:** Historically commissioned by kings, queens, and nobles, this craft requires exceptional artistic precision and specialized skills.
- **Craft Technique:** Master artisans meticulously encrust diamonds, rubies, emeralds, and pearls into gold ornaments like crowns, necklaces, rings, and bangles.
- **Center of Excellence:** Bikaner city in Rajasthan gained national renown as the main center housing generations of hereditary craftsmen practicing this delicate art.

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